

Learn about their money — দোকান করবেন না।

A script for 20–30 merchant interviews. Read the Bangla aloud, keep the English for yourself. **You are not selling anything** — every answer is about how they run their shop today, not what they'd think of your app.

THE 4 RULES — BREAK THESE AND THE ANSWERS BECOME WORTHLESS

✓ **Ask about the past & present.** "How did you handle it last time?" Facts, not "would you use..." opinions.

✗ **Never pitch your idea.** The second you describe an app, they start being polite instead of honest.

✓ **Chase money & specifics.** Real taka amounts, real names, real last week. Vague = dig deeper.

✗ **Don't fill silences.** Ask, then stop talking. Let them think. The gold comes after the pause.

▶ Opening — set them at ease

Warm, short, and make clear you're not here to sell. Ask permission for their time.

আসসালামু আলাইকুম, ভাই। আমি রফিক। আমি ছোট ব্যবসায়ীদের বাকির হিসাব নিয়ে একটু জানার চেষ্টা করছি। আপনার ৫টা মিনিট সময় হবে? আমি কিছু বিক্রি করতে আসিনি — শুধু আপনার অভিজ্ঞতা শুনতে চাই।

"Assalamu alaikum, bhai. I'm Rafiq. I'm trying to understand how small shopkeepers manage their credit (baki). Do you have 5 minutes? I'm not selling anything — I just want to hear about your experience."

01 How they track baki today

Get them describing their **actual current system** — and if you can, get them to show you the notebook.

আপনি এখন বাকির হিসাব কীভাবে রাখেন? একটু দেখাবেন?

How do you keep track of baki right now? Can you show me?

LISTEN FOR Paper khata? Memory? Phone notes? An app? How messy is it?

দিনে বা সপ্তাহে কতজন কাস্টমার বাকিতে জিনিস নেয়?

How many customers buy on credit in a day or a week?

LISTEN FOR Volume — is baki a big part of the business or a side thing?

কোন কাস্টমার কত টাকা বাকি — এটা মনে রাখেন কীভাবে?

How do you remember which customer owes how much?

LISTEN FOR The moment memory or paper fails them.

02 The money at stake

This is the heart of it. Push gently for **real numbers** — the size of the problem is the size of your opportunity.

এই মুহুর্তে মোটামুটি কত টাকা বাকি পড়ে আছে বাজারে, আন্দাজে?

Roughly how much money is out there as unpaid baki right now?

LISTEN FOR An actual taka figure. Big number = big pain.

এর মধ্যে মাসে কত টাকার মতো আর ফেরত আসে না — একদম মার যায়?

Of that, how much never comes back each month — money you simply lose?

LISTEN FOR Their monthly loss. This is the number your app would save.

শেষ কবে বড় অঙ্কের টাকা মার গিয়েছিল? কী হয়েছিল, একটু বলবেন?

When did you last lose a big amount? Tell me what happened.

LISTEN FOR A real story — the emotion tells you how much this hurts.

03 The pain & what they already do

Find out what they've **already tried**. If they've built workarounds or paid for something, the pain is real.

বাকি নিয়ে সবচেয়ে বড় ঝামেলা বা মাথাব্যথা কোনটা?

What's the single most annoying part of dealing with baki?

LISTEN FOR Their words for the problem — use these later in your app.

টাকা তুলতে এখন কী করেন? ফোন দেন, নিজে যান, নাকি মনে করিয়ে দেন?

To collect the money, what do you do now — call, visit, remind them?

LISTEN FOR The collection ritual. This is exactly the job you'd automate.

কাউকে বাকি টাকার কথা মনে করিয়ে দিতে কেমন লাগে?

How does it feel to remind someone about the money they owe?

LISTEN FOR Awkwardness — a neutral SMS reminder solves an emotional pain, not just an admin one.

হিসাবের জন্য মোবাইলে কোনো অ্যাপ ব্যবহার করেছেন কখনো? (যেমন
টালিখাতা / হিসাবপাতি) কেমন লাগলো, এখনো চালান?

Have you ever used a phone app for this (e.g. TallyKhata / HishabPati)? How was it — still using it?

LISTEN FOR Why they quit. That gap is your opening against the incumbents.

04 Willingness to pay — asked indirectly

Never ask "would you pay for an app?" — everyone says yes to be nice. Instead ask about money they've **already spent**.

হিসাব রাখা বা টাকা তোলার জন্য কখনো কোনো কিছু পেছনে টাকা খরচ করেছেন? (খাতা, লোক, SMS?)

Have you ever spent money on tracking or collecting — a ledger, a person, SMS?

LISTEN FOR Any existing spend proves a budget exists for this problem.

কাস্টমারকে SMS বা মেসেজ পাঠাতে টাকা খরচ করেন কখনো?

Do you ever spend money sending SMS or messages to customers?

LISTEN FOR Comfort with paying per-message — your likely first revenue line.

05 Wrap up — referrals & a door back in

আপনার মতো আর কার সাথে এই নিয়ে কথা বলা উচিত বলে মনে করেন?

Who else like you should I talk to about this?

LISTEN FOR Warm introductions — each interview should hand you the next 2.

সামনে যদি এই নিয়ে কিছু বানাই, আপনাকে আরেকবার দেখাতে পারি? আপনার নম্বরটা রাখতে পারি?

If I build something for this later, can I show it to you again? May I keep your number?

LISTEN FOR A yes + a number = your first potential test user.

▸ Reading the room afterwards

↑ BUILD SIGNALS

- ↑ Names a real, painful taka figure lost each month
- ↑ Has an active, messy workaround they hate
- ↑ Tells an emotional story about a bad debt
- ↑ Already spends money chasing collection
- ↑ Asks when your thing will be ready

↓ PIVOT SIGNALS

- ↓ "Baki isn't really a problem for me"
- ↓ Only polite interest, no real numbers
- ↓ Tiny amounts, easily held in memory
- ↓ "Sounds nice" but never tried any solution
- ↓ Won't give a number or a referral

▸ Capture sheet — fill one per merchant

Write it down **right after** you walk away, while it's fresh. Do this for all 20–30.

Interview #_____ · Date _____

SHOP TYPE / VERTICAL

TOTAL BAKI OUTSTANDING (₹)

MONTHLY LOSS / BAD DEBT (₹)

CURRENT SYSTEM

THEIR WORDS FOR THE BIGGEST PAIN

TRIED ANY APP? WHY QUIT?

ALREADY SPENDS ON COLLECTION?

BUILD / PIVOT SIGNAL

FOLLOW-UP? PHONE NUMBER